

Minutes St Columbkille's Parish Council

October 21st 2014

St Columbkille's Church Hall

We opened with the Lord's prayer.

Apologies

Catherine Edvaldsson, Evelyn Kearney, Isobel McCormick

Present

Kathy Thompson, Irene Galt, Mairead Brown, Michelle McGuire, Bernadette Hislop, Maureen Smith, Paul McNeill, Donald Campbell, Hugh Kearney, Deacon Bill McMillan, Marie Tedeschi, Bob McNamara, Fr Pat, Fr Ghislain, Chris Hughes, Patsy Beveridge, Martin Beveridge, Miriam McKernan

Secretary post is unfilled, and Irene Galt kindly agreed to make notes for minutes.

Previous minutes 260814

Projected. Read out

Matters arising

The fabric of the hall.

Francis McKernan made a report on the condition of the hall and submitted it as requested to Ed McGuigan for the building committee. Fr Pat asked that Francis please address small items of work, liaise with Robert McManus, check fire exits, grease hinges, supply door handles and secure electrical power points and dangling window cords. More major internal structural work will require budgeting.

Action MMcK/FMcK

RCIA

There are candidates going through RCIA, and one or two more may join.

Cleaners

The marble steps have been protected from candle wax by a foil base below candles.

Liturgical ministries

Readers held the first meeting in the parish house on October 4th. The next meeting for practice and consolidation of points raised is on November 1st. Chris Hughes has agreed to speak on December 6th on a theme of the spirituality of ministry of the word, and this will be open to all interested persons including readers, Eucharistic ministers, and all interested.

CTS booklets about reading at Mass are available. Fr Pat will distribute these.

Passkeepers

This very important work requires more workers. Fr Pat spoke of the need for parishioners to fill any need they see arising. For example, at some Sunday Masses there is no passkeeper and no collection is taken from the people.

Discussion and agreement took place to advertise in bulletin inviting parishioners to perform any jobs needed that they notice, and to feel welcome.

Action MMcK to advertise in bulletin (complete)

Communications

Hugh Kearney presented from Evelyn a banner borrowed from St John the Baptist Uddingston. It was agreed this would be a useful format for St Columbkille's.

Action Miriam to liaise with Margaret McGrath re printing of A3 poster each week for porch

Stall

Going well, welcome more volunteers, Christmas stock is selling well, storage space is too small.

Minutes: Proposed by Marie Tedeschi, and seconded by Kathy Thompson. Accepted.

Agenda items Oct 21st 2014

Breakfast Club

Fr Pat presented concerns that there are children who may be hungry in Rutherglen. These children receive food at school, but not when school is closed. Discussion took place about identifying children who may benefit from a holiday breakfast club, about who would staff this, about PVG for volunteers, about how the school and the council would be able to advise us. Concerns were expressed about finding volunteers. Fr Pat suggested even one week of the summer break would be good.

Action

Jim Gallagher (SVDP) please assess interest from Caritas pupils, and discuss with Therese Reid (Stonelaw) about taking this forward.

(ps to Jim: do you wish me to approach the Council or the school?)

Sunday teas

We regret the end of the service provided faithfully by three ladies whom we have not supported with additional volunteers.

Fr Pat suggested recommencing teas with teas only. The service at Schoenstatt was mentioned, where one helps oneself from the urn, pays in an

honesty box, and there are no staff serving. We agreed to explore this option with Robert McManus. It would require one person to open the hall and switch on the urn, and cleaning at the end of the café.

Fr Pat hoped that the parish would be grow as a community, and not be used as a filling station for people to top up their spiritual needs once a week without contributing to the community in any other way.

Discussion took place about paying staff to work in the parish. Fr Pat was interested in this, particularly for young people for example in the café.

Action MMcK to ask Robert's advice on recommencing a Sunday café.

The visit of Bishop Joe Toal

Fr Pat outlined the programme, as published in the Sunday bulletin, for the clergy during the day, and for all the parishes at 7pm in the church hall.

It was agreed to publicise from the pulpit the offer of transport for people who would not wish to come out in the dark.

Action Fr Pat (completed)

Passkeepers

Fr Pat expressed concern at a lack of passkeepers, at the loss of contributions at some masses, and at security with theft of handbags.

Action MMcK insert in bulletin re security (complete).

Ministry in general

We regretted the small number of volunteers. Discussion took place about recruiting new helpers.

A suggestion that a representative should speak from each ministry group at Masses, say November for readers, December for Eucharistic ministers, January for passkeepers and so on.

Action Martin Beveridge and Michelle McGuire to contact all parish groups, assess need for new members, assess other needs, plan how to recruit new members.

Action MMcK forward to Martin and Michelle list of parish contacts (complete)

Action all: ask one person every Sunday to contribute to any service/ ministry. New helpers will be able to shadow.

Building update

Paul McNeill reported that the committee are hopeful that the phase 2 works (heating, flooring, electricity and sound, and refurbishment of pews) will commence in January 2014. There is a shortfall

in funding of £605,000. Viridor has granted £240,000, and no more will be offered. The parish has saved £155,000. The hall brings in £24,000 pa. The steering group will update at next meeting.

Miriam thanked all the members of the building committee for their determined work is making good the fabric of the church.

Action MMcK to inform via bulletin of continuing works by building committee

World Youth Day

Fr Ghislain is eager to bring 40-50 youth and two adult mentors to the next event in Stirling 30th July – 2nd August 2015. Chris Hughes recommended approaching the Caritas group at Trlnity. Fr Ghislain has three potential recruits from the school.

Eucharistic ministry

Bob McNamara reported that there is a dedicated and caring team of Eucharistic ministers. All need to have PVG clearance from October 2014, and that work is in progress. Sick people are visited at home and in all eight units at Rodgerpark, David Walker, Abbeyfield and Duncraggan.

He wishes to send a St Columbkille's Christmas card to all those who are visited at home or in homes.

There is to be a meeting of the Eucharistic ministers
November 1st.

Legion of Mary

Marie reported on new members joining, and awaiting PVG clearance. There are 22 new auxiliaries praying for the Legion workers. The Legion is in School this month praying the Rosary.

RCIA

Chris Hughes and Patsy Beveridge joined the council meeting from the RCIA meeting. There are three, possibly four, candidates. The programme is now in week four, meeting on Tuesday evenings.

Divine Mercy Prayer Group

Pat McCarron reported by email on the forthcoming conference in Paisley.

Craft Group

Pat reported by email on the continuing activity of the craft group with people from different churches in Rutherglen. There is an Abba night in November being organised by the group.

First Tuesday Group

Pat McCarron reported by email that the support group for dementia sufferers and their carers is well attended and well supported.

Charismatic Prayer Group

Kathy reported that the prayer group is small and active and commencing the Life in the Spirit Seminars in November.

Altar servers

Michelle reported that the servers meet on the first Sunday of every month. More altar servers are needed. Fr Ghislain asked us to encourage young people to serve.

AOCB

Martin asked if communion under both kinds could be introduced. Fr Pat indicated that a greater number of readers and Eucharistic ministers would facilitate this. Chris reminded us that in past times, communion under both kinds took place at different Masses in rotation. This may be a means of introducing the practice again.

Hugh asked if families coming for baptism could be asked to attend Mass prior to the Baptism. Deacon Bill responded that they are asked. For various reasons, this may not happen. Fr Ghislain was sad that baptised children were not seen at Mass again after their Baptism. Deacon Bill encourages families to attend Mass as a regular practice.

Next meeting 25/11/14 7pm Church Hall.

Minutes prepared by Miriam McKernan 28/10/14